

L27-L28 Power Series Solutions to Linear DEQs

Section 8.3

Consider the DEQ

$$a_2(x)y'' + a_1(x)y' + a_0(x)y = 0 \quad (1)$$

and its standard form

$$y'' + P(x)y' + Q(x)y = 0, \quad \text{always say } y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$$

where $P(x) = \frac{a_1(x)}{a_2(x)}$ and $Q(x) = \frac{a_0(x)}{a_2(x)}$.

Def. A point x_0 is called an ordinary point of eq.(1) if both $P(x)$ and $Q(x)$ are analytic at x_0 .

If x_0 is not an ordinary point, it is called a singular point of the equation.

ex. Classify $x=0$ as an ordinary point or a singular point of the following equations:

1. $\frac{1}{x^2}y'' - \frac{2}{x}y' + y = 0 \Rightarrow y'' - 2x y' + x^2 y = 0$
 $P = -2x$ $Q = x^2$ yes $x=0$ is ordinary.

2. $y'' + \cos x y' - e^x y = 0$
 $P = \cos(x)$ $Q = -e^x$ yes $x=0$ is ordinary

3. $x^2 y'' + 4x y' + x y = 0 \Rightarrow y'' + \frac{4}{x} y' + \frac{1}{x} y = 0$
 $P = \frac{4}{x}$ $Q = \frac{1}{x}$ $\boxed{x=0 \text{ singular}}$

ex. Determine all the singular points of

$$xy'' + \frac{x}{1-x}y' + (\sin x)y = 0$$

standard form

$$\Rightarrow y'' + \frac{1}{1-x}y' + \frac{\sin(x)}{x}y = 0$$

$$P(x) = \frac{1}{1-x} \text{ not analytic at } x=1$$

$$Q(x) = \frac{\sin(x)}{x} = \frac{\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n+1}}{(2n+1)!}}{x} = \frac{(x - \frac{x^3}{3!} + \frac{x^5}{5!} - \dots)}{x}$$

$$= 1 - \frac{x^2}{3!} + \frac{x^4}{5!} - \dots$$

$$= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{x^{2n}}{(2n+1)!}$$

So the only singular point is $x=1$.

Power series method about an ordinary point

To solve $a_2(x)y'' + a_1(x)y' + a_0(x)y = 0$ (Assume y is analytic at x_0):

1. Let $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x-x_0)^n$
2. Find y' and y'' , and substitute them into the DEQ.
3. Find the recurrence relation and solve for a_n .
4. Apply any given initial conditions if applicable.

ex. Find a power series solution about $x = 0$ to

$$y' - \underbrace{2xy}_{\text{ordinary}} = 0.$$

$$1. \quad y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n \rightarrow y' = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n n x^{n-1}$$

$$2. \quad 3. \quad y' - 2xy = 0 \Rightarrow \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n n x^{n-1} - 2x \left(\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n \right) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n n x^{n-1} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} -2a_n x^{n+1} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{n+1} (n+1) x^n + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} -2a_{n-1} x^n = 0$$

$$a_1 \cdot 1 \cdot x^0 + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_{n+1} (n+1) x^n + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} -2a_{n-1} x^n = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow a_1 + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} [a_{n+1}(n+1) - 2a_{n-1}] x^n = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{cases} a_1 = 0 & (n=0) \\ a_{n+1}(n+1) - 2a_{n-1} = 0, & n \geq 1 \end{cases}$$

$$\Rightarrow a_{n+1} = \frac{2a_{n-1}}{n+1}, \quad n \geq 1$$

recurrence relation.

$$n=0: a_1 = 0$$

$$n=1: a_2 = \frac{2a_0}{2} = a_0 = \frac{2}{2} a_0 = \frac{1}{1!} a_0$$

$$n=2: a_3 = \frac{2a_1}{3} = \frac{2}{3} \cdot 0 = 0$$

$$n=3: a_4 = \frac{2a_2}{4} = \frac{1}{2} a_0 = \frac{2}{4} \cdot \frac{2}{2} a_0 = \frac{1}{2!} a_0$$

$$n=4: a_5 = \frac{2a_3}{5} = 0$$

$$n=5: a_6 = \frac{2a_4}{6} = \frac{2}{6} \cdot \frac{2}{4} \cdot \frac{2}{2} a_0 = \frac{1}{3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1} a_0 = \frac{1}{6} a_0 = \frac{1}{3!} a_0$$

$$a_{\text{odd}} = 0$$

$$a_{2n} = \frac{1}{n!} a_0$$

$$n=7: a_8 = \frac{2a_6}{8} = \frac{2}{8} \cdot \frac{2}{6} \cdot \frac{2}{4} \cdot \frac{2}{2} a_0 = \frac{1}{4!} a_0$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{So } y &= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = \underbrace{\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{2n} x^{2n}}_{\text{even index}} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{2n+1} x^{2n+1} \\ &= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n!} a_0 x^{2n} = a_0 \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n!} x^{2n} = a_0 e^{x^2} \end{aligned}$$

ex. Find a power series solution about $x = 0$ to

$$y'' + y = 0. \quad \Rightarrow y = c_1 \cos(x) + c_2 \sin(x)$$

$$\left\{ \begin{aligned} y &= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n, \quad y' = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1}, \quad y'' = \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1) a_n x^{n-2} \\ y'' + y &= \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \underbrace{n(n-1)}_{\substack{\downarrow 2 \\ \uparrow 2}} a_n x^{n-2} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0 \\ \Rightarrow \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (n+2)(n+1) a_{n+2} x^n + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n &= 0 \\ \Rightarrow \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \underbrace{[(n+2)(n+1) a_{n+2} + a_n]}_{=0} x^n &= 0 \end{aligned} \right.$$

$$\left\{ \begin{aligned} \Rightarrow (n+2)(n+1) a_{n+2} + a_n &= 0, \quad n \geq 0 \\ \Rightarrow \boxed{a_{n+2} = \frac{-a_n}{(n+2)(n+1)}}, \quad n \geq 0 \end{aligned} \right. \quad \begin{array}{l} \text{recurrence} \\ \text{relation} \\ y'' + y = 0 \\ \text{second order} \end{array}$$

$$\left\{ \begin{aligned} n=0: \quad a_2 &= \frac{-a_0}{2 \cdot 1} = -1 \cdot \frac{1}{2 \cdot 1} a_0 = \frac{-1}{2!} a_0 \quad \text{two constants } a_0, a_1 \\ n=1: \quad a_3 &= \frac{-a_1}{3 \cdot 2} = -1 \cdot \frac{1}{3 \cdot 2} a_1 = \frac{-1}{3!} a_1 \\ n=2: \quad a_4 &= \frac{-a_2}{4 \cdot 3} = -1 \cdot \frac{1}{4 \cdot 3} \cdot (-1) \frac{1}{2 \cdot 1} a_0 = \frac{(-1)^2}{4!} a_0 \\ n=3: \quad a_5 &= \frac{-a_3}{5 \cdot 4} = -1 \cdot \frac{1}{5 \cdot 4} \cdot (-1) \frac{1}{3 \cdot 2} a_1 = \frac{(-1)^2}{5!} a_1 \end{aligned} \right.$$

$$n=4: a_6 = \frac{-a_4}{6 \cdot 5} = \frac{-1}{6 \cdot 5} \cdot \frac{(-1)^2}{4!} a_0 = \frac{(-1)^3}{6!} a_0$$

$$n=5: a_7 = \frac{-a_5}{7 \cdot 6} = \frac{-1}{7 \cdot 6} \cdot \frac{(-1)^2}{5!} a_1 = \frac{(-1)^3}{7!} a_1$$

$$a_n = \begin{cases} \frac{(-1)^m}{(2m)!} a_0 = a_{2m} & n \text{ even}, n=2m \\ \frac{(-1)^m}{(2m+1)!} a_1 = a_{2m+1} & n \text{ odd}, n=2m+1 \end{cases}$$

(4) So $y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{2n} x^{2n} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{2n+1} x^{2n+1}$

$$= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{(2n)!} a_0 x^{2n} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{(2n+1)!} a_1 x^{2n+1}$$

$$= a_0 \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{(2n)!} x^{2n} + a_1 \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{(2n+1)!} x^{2n+1}$$

$$= a_0 \cos(x) + a_1 \sin(x)$$

ex. Find a general solution to

$$2y'' + xy' + y = 0$$

in the form of a power series about $x = 0$.
 $\uparrow$ variable coefficient

$$\text{let } y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$$

$$2y'' + xy' + y = 2 \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1) a_n x^{n-2} + x \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} 2(n)(n-1) a_n x^{n-2} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^n + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} 2(n+2)(n+1) a_{n+2} x^n + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^n + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0$$

separate $n=0$ terms:

$$\underbrace{[2(2)(1)a_2 x^0 + a_0 x^0]}_{n=0} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} [2(n+2)(n+1)a_{n+2} + \underbrace{n a_n + a_n}] x^n = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{cases} 4a_2 + a_0 = 0 & (n=0) \\ 2(n+2)(n+1)a_{n+2} + (n+1)a_n = 0, & n \geq 1 \end{cases}$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{a_{n+2} = \frac{-\cancel{(n+1)}a_n}{2(n+2)\cancel{(n+1)}} = \frac{-a_n}{2(n+2)}, n \geq 1}$$

recurrence relation

$$n=0: 4a_2 + a_0 = 0 \Rightarrow a_2 = -\frac{1}{4}a_0$$

$$n=1: a_3 = \frac{-a_1}{2(3)} = \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 3} a_1$$

$$n=2: a_4 = \frac{-a_2}{2(4)} = \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 4} \cdot \frac{-1}{4} a_0$$

$$n=3: a_5 = \frac{-a_3}{2 \cdot 5} = \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 5} \cdot \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 3} a_1$$

$$n=4: a_6 = \frac{-a_4}{2 \cdot 6} = \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 6} \cdot \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 4} \cdot \frac{-1}{4} a_0 = \frac{(-1)^3}{2^3 \cdot 2 \cdot 4 \cdot 6} a_0$$

$$= \frac{(-1)^3}{2^3 \cdot 2^3 (1 \cdot 2 \cdot 3)} a_0$$

$$= \frac{(-1)^3}{2^6 3!} a_0$$

$$n=5: a_7 = \frac{-a_5}{2 \cdot 7} = \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 7} \cdot \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 5} \cdot \frac{-1}{2 \cdot 3} a_1$$

$$= \frac{(-1)^3}{2^3 \cdot 3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7} a_1$$

in general

$$a_n = \begin{cases} \frac{(-1)^m}{2^{2m} m!} a_0, & n=2m \text{ (even)} \\ \frac{(-1)^m}{2^m \cdot 3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7 \cdots (2m+1)} a_1, & n=2m+1 \end{cases}$$

$(2m+1)!!$

$$\text{So } y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{2n} x^{2n} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{2n+1} x^{2n+1}$$

$$= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{2^{2n} n!} a_0 x^{2n} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{2^n \cdot 3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7 \cdots (2n+1)} a_1 x^{2n+1}$$

$$a_0 \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \left(\frac{x}{2}\right)^{2n} = a_0 \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \left(\frac{x^2}{4}\right)^n = a_0 e^{-x^2/4}$$

$$y = a_0 e^{-x^2/4} + a_1 \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{2^n \cdot 3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7 \cdots (2n+1)} x^{2n+1}$$

So $y_1 = e^{-x^2/4}$ is a solution to $2y'' + xy' + y = 0$
 $\Rightarrow y'' + \underline{\frac{x}{2}}y' + \frac{1}{2}y = 0$
Reduction of Order: y_1 soln, y_2
 $p(x) = \frac{x}{2}$

$$y_2 = y_1 \int \frac{e^{-\int p(x) dx}}{y_1^2} dx$$

$$\Rightarrow y_2 = e^{-x^2/4} \int \frac{e^{-\int \frac{x}{2} dx}}{(e^{-x^2/4})^2} dx = e^{-x^2/4} \int \frac{e^{-x^2/4}}{(e^{-x^2/4})^2} dx$$

$$= e^{-x^2/4} \int e^{x^2/4} dx$$

error function: $\text{erf}(x) = \frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi}} \int_0^x e^{-t^2} dt$

ex. Find at least the first four nonzero terms in a power series expansion about $x = 0$ for the solution to the IVP:

$$y'' + (x-2)y' - y = 0 \quad \left| \quad y(0) = -1, \quad y'(0) = 0 \right.$$

$$y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = a_0 + a_1 x + a_2 x^2 + \dots$$

$$y(0) = a_0 = -1$$

$$y' = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1} = a_1 + 2a_2 x + \dots$$

$$y'(0) = a_1 = 0$$

$$y'' + (x-2)y' - y = \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1)a_n x^{n-2} + \underbrace{(x-2)}_{\substack{\uparrow 1 \\ \downarrow 1}} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1} - \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0$$

$$= \sum_{\substack{n=2 \\ \downarrow 2}}^{\infty} \underbrace{n(n-1)a_n x^{n-2}}_{\uparrow 2} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^n - \sum_{\substack{n=1 \\ \downarrow 1}}^{\infty} \underbrace{2n a_n x^{n-1}}_{\uparrow 1} - \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0$$

$$= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (n+2)(n+1)a_{n+2} x^n + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^n - \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} 2(n+1)a_{n+1} x^n - \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0$$

$$[2a_2 - 2a_1 - a_0] + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} [(n+2)(n+1)a_{n+2} + \underline{n a_n} - 2(n+1)a_{n+1} - \underline{a_n}] x^n = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{cases} 2a_2 - 2a_1 - a_0 = 0 & (n=0) \\ (n+2)(n+1)a_{n+2} - 2(n+1)a_{n+1} + (n-1)a_n = 0, & n \geq 1 \end{cases}$$

$$\Rightarrow a_{n+2} = \frac{2(n+1)a_{n+1} - (n-1)a_n}{(n+2)(n+1)}, n \geq 1$$

$$\bullet a_0 = -1$$

$$\bullet a_1 = 0$$

$$\bullet 2a_2 - 2a_1 - a_0 = 0 \Rightarrow 2a_2 = 2a_1 + a_0 = 2 \cdot 0 + (-1)$$

$$\Rightarrow a_2 = -\frac{1}{2}$$

$$\bullet n=1, a_3 = \frac{2(2)a_2 - (1-1)a_1}{3 \cdot 2} = \frac{4(-\frac{1}{2}) - 0}{6} = -\frac{1}{3}$$

$$\Rightarrow a_3 = -\frac{1}{3}$$

$$\bullet n=2, a_4 = \frac{2(3)a_3 - (2-1)a_2}{4 \cdot 3} = \frac{-2 + \frac{1}{2}}{12} = -\frac{1}{8}$$

$$\Rightarrow a_4 = -\frac{1}{8}$$

$$\text{so } y = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = a_0 + a_1 x + a_2 x^2 + a_3 x^3 + a_4 x^4 + \dots$$

$$= -1 + 0 \cdot x + (-\frac{1}{2})x^2 + (-\frac{1}{3})x^3 + (-\frac{1}{8})x^4 + \dots$$

$$= -1 - \frac{1}{2}x^2 - \frac{1}{3}x^3 - \frac{1}{8}x^4 + \dots$$